

Botany Lessons





About the Course

An elective in Life Science, Botany guides learners through the basic foundations of the discipline, while incorporating historical context, modern developments, current events, and citizenship. This course provides guidance and flexibility for teachers and learners to adjust the course for personal needs and preferences.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Botany



Placement & Combining Tips

There are no specific prerequisites or concurrents for this course.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Botany Lessons 5 times/week 45 min	A Peterson Field Guide To Western Trees Botany in a Day Growing a Revolution: Bringing Our Soil Back to Life Pacific Coast Tree Finder Rocky Mountain Tree Finder Shanley's Quest Card Game The Milkweed Lands: An Epic Story of One Plant: Its Nature and Ecology Oaxaca Journal Tree Finder - Eastern US What a Plant Knows Winter Tree Finder (Eastern US) The Hidden Life of Trees: The Illustrated Edition The Sibley Guide to Trees Elementary Studies in Plant Life

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Botany				
Botany Lessons Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 9-12	Botany Lessons	Botany Lessons	Botany Lessons Nature Notebook: Grades 9-12	Botany Lessons Botany Labs



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Botany Lessons

☐ Select a science book from the Alveary bookshelf for personal reading time, as appropriate.

☐ Bookmark or print Quick Links, as needed.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

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☐ Gather household items, typically easy for students to scavenge or teachers to obtain locally:

- various plants specimens, found or obtained as detailed in Elementary Plant Studies
- lily flower (Term 1)
- found twigs and fruits/seeds
- needle and/or blade for dissecting
- forceps/tweezers for dissecting
- large, transparent cup/glass
- masking tape
- aluminum foil
- 2 glass jars
- salt
- oil
- microscope coverslips and slides
- paper towels
- saucer
- recycled box
- pins
- cotton ball
- various corks
- recycled measuring spoon/cup marked in tsp/Tbsp or mL
- recycled apple corer or trowel
- place to dig soil
- distilled water
- zip top sandwich bags for soil samples
- small jars with secure lid for each soil sample
- dropper
- pea/bean seeds
- potting materials
- denatured alcohol
- iodine
- potato
- matches
- candle
- red food coloring/dye
- straw
- materials by student choice
- optional: tulip bulb

Reminders

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☐ Note that Lab in week 7 requires a lily flower. Make a calendar note to obtain this closer to the appropriate time.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Botany Lessons



A Peterson Field Guide To Western Trees



Botany in a Day



Growing a Revolution: Bringing Our Soil Back to Life



Pacific Coast Tree Finder



Rocky Mountain Tree Finder



Shanleya's Quest Card Game



The Milkweed Lands: An Epic Story of One Plant: Its Nature and Ecology



Oaxaca Journal



Tree Finder - Eastern US



What a Plant Knows



Winter Tree Finder (Eastern US)



The Hidden Life of Trees: The Illustrated Edition



The Sibley Guide to Trees



Elementary Studies in Plant Life



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Botany Lessons

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Seek app from iNaturalist](#)

∞ [Nature Journal Connection](#)

∞ [Alveary Bookshelf](#)

∞ [Elementary Studies in Plant Life](#)

∞ [Elementary Studies in Plant Life Annotations](#)

∞ [AmScope key for slide IDs](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Botany Lessons

How To Approach



Introduce

- If starting a new book or a new topic in the book, then look at the title or a picture and take a moment to consider previous ideas and experiences.
- If continuing a previous reading, recap what was read previously. Often, the title of the book's section can help to draw out the main idea.



Read

- Read or do, as instructed in the lessons, making note of or flagging unfamiliar terms, interesting ideas, important dates, inspiring quotes, etc.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- As they read, learners record ideas in a notebook or binder using outlines, diagrams, graphic organizers, or other methods (or a combination of methods) that suit them. These recordings can be a helpful mechanism for remembering or a mini-narration to support understanding.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try reading over the passage again, studying a picture or diagram, connecting the idea to something from real life, or practicing chapter exercises. The lab/field work further supports major concepts from the text.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling, defining a concept, explaining the links in a chain of thought, etc. Do this orally or silently to yourself.
- Use words, pictures, outlines, etc.
- If a particular idea cannot be narrated, then read or examine the text again.



Discuss

- Consider with the teacher any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.
- If understanding is still uncertain, try rereading the passage or do some personal research on the topic.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, or pursue additional reading, depending on student interest.

Botany Lessons

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 1

Botany Literature

Materials: What a Plant Knows

→ INTRO

At least one day each week will be spent reading important works of botanical literature. The lesson plans give you an idea of how many pages to read each week to finish the book by the end of the term. If one day is not enough, you might read about half on one day and half on the flex day. If one day is enough, then decide how you would like to use your flex day. Consider the ideas provided on Day 4 of the week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read about 14 pages per week; p.3-17.

→ WRITE

Write a narration in your Botany Notebook.

• PLAN WEEKLY

- ☐ Nature walk - Look for the plants and/or features mentioned in your books. Record observations.
- ☐ science free read

WEEK 1 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 2

How Plants Work, Life Cycle of Flowering Plants

Materials: Elementary Studies in Plant Life

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1. Work through the material, adding drawings to your notebook. You may need to visit local nurseries, botanical gardens, neighbors' yards, and gardens to find specimens to examine. Pick a question at the end to answer fully in your notebook for your narration.

WEEK 1 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 3

Identification

Materials: Botany in a Day

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Forward, Region Covered, and p.1-9

→ NOTE

You may or may not agree with the author's presentation of the evolution of plants. Still, it is important to know current botanical thinking, especially as we seek to understand how plants have been organized. This will help us as we begin to learn plant families.

WEEK 1 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 4

Flex Day

Materials: Selected botany literature OR lab/field supplies

→ INTRO

Use this flex day to finish the week's reading from What a Plant Knows, or continue any lab/field activities. Suppose you have completed the week's activities. In that case, you may use this day to tailor the course to be more literary by reading an additional text, such as Growing a Revolution, or more active by pursuing a special study of interest.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 ☐ 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 5

Special Study

☐ Materials: The Milkweed Lands

→ INTRO

Notice how the author and illustrator make a study of and learn so much about this one plant. Whether you have milkweed near you and can notice their observations, or you make a similar study of a particular plant in your locale, enjoy their method as you develop your own.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Half of Ch.1 (to the end of "Dangerous Colors" p.8)

WEEK 2 ☐ 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 6

Botany Literature

☐ Materials: What a Plant Knows

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read about 14 pages per week; p.17-31.

→ WRITE

Write a narration in your Botany Notebook.

• PLAN WEEKLY

☐ Nature walk - Look for the plants and/or features mentioned in your books. Record observations.

☐ science free read

WEEK 2 ☐ 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 7

How Plants Work, Use of Water

☐ Materials: Elementary Studies in Plant Life

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2

WEEK 2 ☐ 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 8

Identification

☐ Materials: Botany in a Day

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10-18

WEEK 2 ☐ 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 9

Flex Day

☐ Materials: Selected botany literature OR lab/field supplies

→ NOTE

Use this flex day to finish the week's reading from What a Plant Knows, or continue any lab/field activities. Suppose you have completed these activities for the week. In that case, you may use this day to tailor the course to be more literary by reading an additional text, such as Growing a Revolution, or more active by pursuing a special study of interest.

WEEK 2 ☐ 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 10

Special Study

☐ Materials: The Milkweed Lands

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.1 from p.8.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 11

Botany Literature

Materials: What a Plant Knows

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read about 14 pages per week; p.31-45.

→ WRITE

Write a narration in your Botany Notebook.

• PLAN WEEKLY

Nature walk - Look for the plants and/or features mentioned in your books. Record observations.

science free read

WEEK 3 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 12

How Plants Work, Soil Science

Materials: Links

→ INTRO

Scientists now know that soil science is fundamentally important to plant growth and even human health. This is because of the vast number of organisms that live in the soil food web. Look at a basic diagram of this web at the link and copy it into your Botany Notebook. Then, watch the videos to consider how it works and why it's important.

→ VIEW

Image Link: Soil Food Web

→ VIEW, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Video Link: The Living Soil Beneath Our Feet (2:49)

Video Link: How Regenerative Agriculture Brings Life Back (15:22)

WEEK 3 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 13

Identification

Materials: Botany in a Day, Shanleya's Quest card game

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-21

→ VIEW

Watch the author explain further.

Link: Tutorial

Link: Written Explanation in larger print from the website

→ PLAY

Find a friend and begin playing the card games to familiarize yourself with the families and recognize the patterns.

WEEK 3 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 14

Flex Day

Materials: Selected botany literature OR lab/field supplies

→ NOTE

Use this flex day to finish the week's reading from What a Plant Knows or continue any lab/field activities. Suppose you have completed these activities for the week. In that case, you may use this day to tailor the course to be more literary by reading an additional text, such as Growing a Revolution, or more active by pursuing a special study of interest.

Botany Lessons

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 45m Botany Lessons - Lesson 15

Special Study

Materials: The Milkweed Lands

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Half of Ch.2 (to p.27)

SAMPLE